

as I wanted to love that activity, I had to lay it down and move on if I was going to fully live out values-based spending.

Second, you have to replace shopping with activities of equal effort and reward. If you tend to impulse shop on your phone before bed, then going for a run is not a suitable activity to replace it with. Instead, look for something fun you can do on your phone in your pajamas like playing a game, doing a language-learning app, or finding recipes for your next meal plan. Ultimately, it'll be up to you to decide the activities that give you a comparable dopamine hit. It's a good idea to make a list of things to try that are different "sizes." Scrolling on your phone or reading a book are small size. They require very low mental and physical effort. Here are some more small-size ideas:

- Get a book from your library's app
- Text a friend
- Start a gratitude journal
- Listen to a new album (or an oldie but goodie!)
- Plan a bucket-list trip
- Make a bucket list
- Clean your email inbox
- Organize and declutter your digital photos

Then there are medium-size activities that might replace shopping habits you'd leave your house for. Like it's late afternoon, I'm bored, and I want to experience the surreal joy of walking around Target or checking out Kohl's because they're having their famous "second week in August" sale. This is where you could replace shopping with something physical like going for a walk, run, or bike ride. Physical doesn't even have to mean exercise. You could also choose a hobby like knitting, coloring, or anything that requires you to move your body. Here are some other ideas:

- Experiment with a new hairstyle
- Call a friend
- Declutter a drawer